

HISTORY HACK • DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

Document-Based Question

US.16 — Explain the roles played by muckrakers and progressive idealists, including: • Jane Addams • Jacob Riis • Upton Sinclair • Lincoln Steffens • Ida Tarbell • Ida B. Wells-Barnett

US.18 — Analyze the goals and achievements of the Progressive movement, including: • Adoption of the initiative, referendum, and recall • Adoption of the primary system • 16th Amendment • 17th Amendment

US.20 — Describe the movement to achieve suffrage for women, including the significance of: • Leaders such as Carrie Chapman Catt, Anne Dallas Dudley, and Alice Paul • Activities of suffragists • Passage of the 19th Amendment, including the role of Tennessee • Legacy of Susan B. Anthony

TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

The sources

Document 1

Upton Sinclair, *The Jungle*, Chapter XIV, 1906. Project Gutenberg / Library of Congress.

“There were the men in the pickle rooms, for instance, where old Antanas had gotten his death; scarce a one of these that had not some spot of horror on his person. Let a man so much as scrape his finger pushing a truck in the pickle rooms, and he might have a sore that would put him out of the world; all the joints in his fingers might be eaten by the acid, one by one. Of the butchers and floorsmen, the beef-boners and trimmers, and all those who used knives, you could scarcely find a person who had the use of his thumb; time and again the base of it had been slashed, till it was a mere lump of flesh against which the man pressed the knife to hold it.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

H — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

I — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

P — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

P — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

Document 2

Ida M. Tarbell, *The History of the Standard Oil Company*, Volume II, Chapter XXVI, 1904. Originally published by McClure's Magazine; available through the Library of Congress.

“If the Standard Oil Company or its officers had been brought to trial on charges of violating the Interstate Commerce Act... it is probable that they would have been punished for some of these practices. But such a trial was never had. The reason generally given for the failure of the government to act was that Congress had not yet passed the legislation which would make such prosecution possible — but that the legislation had not been passed was due in large measure to the influence of the Standard itself upon Congress.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 2

H — Historical context

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Document 3

Theodore Roosevelt, Message to Congress on the Pure Food and Drug Legislation, June 1906.
National Archives, Presidential Messages to Congress.

“I recommend that a law be enacted to regulate interstate commerce in misbranded and adulterated foods, drinks, and drugs. Such a law would protect legitimate manufacture and commerce, and would tend to secure the health and welfare of the consuming public. The Federal inspection of meats should be thorough enough to guarantee that no diseased, filthy, or unwholesome product reaches the consumer... The revelations made by recent investigations make it evident that we cannot rely upon State laws or State officials alone.”

SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 3

H — Historical context

What was happening when
this was made?

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Who was meant to read or
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Who is speaking, and how
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The question

Apply HIPP to each document, construct a clear argument, use all three documents as evidence, and add at least two outside historical facts.

Plan your answer

Your claim	
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Source	Evidence you will use	Why it supports your claim
Document 1		
Document 2		
Document 3		
Outside knowledge		

Write your response

Scoring guide

Pts	6-point scale
6	Exemplary. Constructs a sophisticated argument about journalism as necessary but not sufficient, and explains what additional factors were required for reform. Applies HIPP to all three documents, using point of view and purpose in particular to evaluate the reliability and limits of each source as evidence. Incorporates two or more outside historical facts. Demonstrates cross-document synthesis — e.g., showing how Tarbell's evidence about Standard Oil's congressional influence contextualizes why Sinclair's food safety impact was exceptional rather than typical. Response evaluates the relative importance of journalism, political leadership, and economic interests.
5	Advanced. Clear argument with HIPP of all three documents. Two outside facts. Cross-document synthesis present. Relative importance of factors addressed but less fully weighed than exemplary.
4	Proficient. Clear argument with HIPP of two documents. One outside fact. Identifies journalism as necessary but not sufficient without fully developing why.
3	Adequate. Takes a position on journalism's effectiveness but it is general. HIPP of one document. One outside fact.
2	Developing. Summarizes the documents. No analytical framework or insufficient HIPP application.
1	Beginning. Lists document information without argument.
0	No response or off-topic.

Expected evidence and document analysis. DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS (HIPP): Doc 1 — Sinclair: purpose was labor reform, not food safety — the disconnect between intent and impact is critical evidence for evaluating journalism's limits. Doc 2 — Tarbell: purpose is to expose regulatory capture — she demonstrates that journalism that lacks executive or judicial backing can be neutralized by corporate power over Congress. Doc 3 — Roosevelt: purpose is to demonstrate executive agency — he converts Sinclair's moral outrage into a political argument for federal jurisdiction, the step journalism alone cannot take. KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Pure Food and Drug Act (1906) and Federal Meat Inspection Act (1906); Sinclair's socialist intent vs. food safety outcome; Tarbell's 5-year investigation and the 7-year gap before Standard Oil dissolution; Lincoln Steffens *The Shame of the Cities* (1904) and its limited legislative impact; the Beef Trust's eventual support of federal inspection; the Bureau of Corporations as TR's preferred investigative tool; the role of consumer advocacy organizations in building public pressure for Pure Food legislation before Sinclair wrote *The Jungle*.

Sourcing. Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

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